WILL SILK

SENIOR RECRUITER • RPO & TALENT ACQUISITION • RECRUITMENT OPERATIONS

Cape Town, South Africa • UK Citizen • Available Immediately • Fully Remote • Any Time Zone (UK / US / EU)
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior recruitment and RPO specialist with 5+ years of full-lifecycle experience across sourcing, delivery, operations and stakeholder management in UK, US and international markets. Consistently delivers measurable outcomes — 40% reduction in time-to-hire, 85–90% offer-acceptance rate and 95% client satisfaction — across contingent, RPO, executive search and high-volume hiring. Strong in building structured hiring operations from scratch, hard-to-fill vacancies and embedded RPO delivery. Integrates AI and workflow automation to improve speed and consistency without sacrificing candidate quality or recruiter judgement.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **40% reduction in time-to-hire** — delivered through structured recruitment workflows, redesigned intake processes and optimised screening frameworks across multiple RPO engagements.
- **5 previously long-open positions filled within 8 weeks** — rebuilt sourcing and intake process for a US digital marketing and technology RPO client with stalled pipelines.
- **200+ hires per month at peak (team output)** — part of a high-volume RPO delivery team, owning my share of sourcing, screening and pipeline throughput across concurrent campaigns.
- **85–90% offer-acceptance rate** — achieved through proactive candidate engagement, accurate salary benchmarking and thorough interview preparation.
- **95% client satisfaction** — maintained across multiple engagements and markets through consistent delivery, process clarity and strong stakeholder relationships.
- **50+ South African professionals** — sourced and placed into remote roles across the UK, US and international markets in specialist and hard-to-fill disciplines.

CORE EXPERTISE

Recruitment: RPO & Contract Recruitment • Full-Cycle Recruitment • 180 Recruitment / Resourcing • Talent Acquisition • Executive & Senior Search • Technical & Specialist Recruitment • Blue-Collar & Skilled Trades • International Recruitment • Hard-to-Fill Vacancies • Headhunting & Passive Candidate Mapping

Delivery & Operations: Vacancy Intake & Briefing • Market Mapping • Boolean / X-Ray Search • LinkedIn Recruiter • Candidate Screening & Qualification • Structured Interviews • Pipeline Management • Interview Coordination • Offer Support • ATS / CRM Management • KPI Tracking & Reporting • SOP Development • Workflow Optimisation

Stakeholder & Performance: Stakeholder Management • Client Management • Candidate Engagement • Cross-Border Recruitment • Remote Recruitment Operations • Recruitment Analytics • Data-Informed Decision Making • Lean Six Sigma • Kanban / Kaizen

AI & Technology: AI-Powered Recruiting • AI-Assisted Sourcing & Screening • Candidate Matching • Generative AI • Prompt Engineering • Recruitment Workflow Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Talent Manager (Global Talent & RPO) | Advanced Digital Automotive Group (ADAG)

Mar 2026 – Aug 2026 | Remote · US Market

- Led global hiring strategy and RPO delivery across digital marketing, technology, operations and senior-management requirements in a fast-paced US-facing environment.
- Owned the full recruitment lifecycle: vacancy intake, sourcing strategy, candidate screening and assessment, stakeholder communication and end-to-end delivery — achieving a 40% reduction in time-to-hire.
- Built the organisation's first structured hiring function: intake SOPs, screening frameworks, ATS configuration and KPI-driven pipeline reporting, creating a scalable and repeatable operation.
- Directed offshore recruitment support across sourcing, screening and pipeline administration while retaining full accountability for candidate quality and delivery outcomes.

Co-Founder & RPO Recruitment Consultant | Bridgeway Talent Partners AI

Nov 2025 – Present · Independent consultancy | Remote · UK & International

- Founded and operate an independent RPO and specialist recruitment consultancy delivering retained-search, contingent and project-based recruitment across technical, engineering and skilled-trades markets.
- Own the full recruitment lifecycle from vacancy intake and sourcing strategy through direct outreach, screening, structured interviews, shortlisting, client presentation, offer management and onboarding.
- Build evidence-led pipelines using Boolean/X-Ray search, LinkedIn Recruiter, referrals, job boards, market mapping and AI-assisted workflows.

RPO & Contract Recruitment Engagements | 2023 – 2025 · Remote · UK / US / International

- Independent contractor across a series of embedded RPO engagements (multiple clients, not a single employer) in US digital marketing, technology, high-volume BPO and renewable energy.
- Delivered sourcing, structured screening, pipeline management and stakeholder reporting — including filling 5 long-open roles within 8 weeks for a US digital marketing client, and recruiting electrical engineers and certified installation teams for Terawatt Solar (Cape Town, 2023).

Freelance Recruitment Specialist | Top Company Consultants (Pty) Ltd

May 2022 – Dec 2024 | Remote · International

- Delivered concurrent recruitment assignments for international clients across technology, digital, finance/FinTech, operations and specialist professional markets.
- Managed candidate sourcing, qualification, interview coordination and stakeholder communication across multiple live mandates simultaneously.
- Used proactive sourcing, market mapping and direct outreach to identify and engage candidates for specialist and hard-to-fill requirements.

Medical Recruiter | British Nursing Association / A24 Group

Mar 2021 – Nov 2022 | Cape Town · UK Healthcare Recruitment

- Delivered full-cycle recruitment for UK healthcare clients including Nurses, Carers and Pharmacists across concurrent high-volume mandates.
- Managed high-volume sourcing, structured screening, compliance checking and credential verification across concurrent client requirements.

Earlier Career | Global Travel & Client Operations · ~10 Years (Lufthansa InTouch & Key Travel)

Senior international roles supporting complex client relationships across time zones — strong foundations in communication, service delivery, negotiation, stakeholder management and high-pressure operational environments, directly transferable to recruitment delivery.

RECRUITMENT TECHNOLOGY & TOOLS

ATS / Recruitment: Recruiterflow • Bullhorn • OpenCATS • Manatal • Workable • Greenhouse • Zoho Recruit

Sourcing: LinkedIn Recruiter • Boolean / X-Ray Search • Indeed • Direct Outreach • Market Mapping

AI / Automation: ChatGPT • Claude • Perplexity • Gemini • AI-Assisted Sourcing • CV Screening • Candidate Matching

CRM / Workflow / Analytics: HubSpot • Salesforce • Google Workspace • Microsoft 365 • Asana • Monday.com • ClickUp • Airtable • Power BI • Tableau

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Recruitment: Recruitment Analytics Professional • AI-Powered Recruiter • Executive Search Specialist • ATS & Talent Acquisition Expert • Recruitment Automation — NextInHR (2026) • Generative AI, Recruiting & Talent Acquisition • LinkedIn Recruiter: AI-Powered Talent Acquisition — LinkedIn Learning (2025) • Talent Acquisition Practices — Alison (2026) • Safer Recruitment — Alison (2024)

AI: AI Fluency Framework & Foundations • Claude 101 • Claude Code 101 • AI Fluency for Nonprofits — Anthropic (2026) • AI Operator — Techademy Global (2026) • Strategic Planning in the AI Age — HP LIFE (2026) • Prompt Engineering Principles — Udemy (2024)

Process & Digital: Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt (2025) • ITIL® V4 — Simplilearn (2024) • Google Africa Digital Marketing — Google (2022) • Google AI Ads & GA4 (2026) • HubSpot Inbound (2026) • Customer Success Fundamentals — CustomerSuccessU (2026)

EDUCATION

NQF Level 3 — Electrical & Electronics Engineering | College of Cape Town | 2001–2003

